

## THE TORRENT QUICKSTART

Games set in the Torrent are heavily based on heists and other clandestine missions called Gigs, and on the criminal connections players form while pulling them off.

The player characters are referred to as Operators, working together in a crew. Each Gig should be an opportunity for the Digital MasterMind (DMM) to build an overarching narrative by tying in the Operators' existing connections or introducing them to new characters or organizations that will come back later. For the players, a Gig should be an opportunity to leverage existing connections to their advantage or form new ones to benefit them in the future.

The Torrent uses a highly flexible ability and equipment system. There are no classes or levels. Instead, players can mix and match to find a unique playstyle. Players can gain additional abilities when they reach a milestone, determined by the DMM.

The setting is a satirical and whimsical setting riffing off of online spaces and games. Because of this, characters, locations, and storylines in this setting can include almost anything– A weapons-dealing taco truck staffed entirely by Hatsune Miku clones, for instance.

| CHARACTER CREATION QUICK REFERENCE | |
|---|---|
| Total Skill Ranks: | 14 |
| Skill Ranks from Background: | 3 |
| Skill Ranks from Occupation: | 3 |
| Skill Ranks from Free Allocation: | 8 |
| Trait Scores: | (Ranks/2)+1 |
| Speed: | 5+Cool |
| Stability Points: | 7+Humanity |
| Stability Levels: | 2 |
| Firewall: | 10+Intellect |
| Fatigue Limit: | 3 |
| RAM: | 12 |
| Hardware Slots: | 4 |
| Avatar Abilities: | 2 |
| Software: | 3 |
| Hardware: | 1 |
| Allies: | 1 |
| Enemies: | 1 |
| Debts: | 2 |

## CHARACTER CREATION

### Step 1: Stats

Several steps in character creation require adding ranks to your character's skills. Characters in Ther Torrent have 16 skills that represent their proficiency in performing various tasks. The number of ranks in that skill determines the number of dice you roll when making a skill check. In addition, each character has 3 traits: Cool, Humanity, and Intellect. Each skill is related to one of these traits.

**The 16 skills listed under their related traits are as follows:**

**Cool:** Represents one's ability to stay calm under pressure and take control of situations.

- **Aura**: Intimidation and awe.
- **Conceal**: Stealth and sleight of hand.
- **Aware**: Passive perception and attention to detail.
- **Deceive**: Verbal misdirection and cunning.
- **Perform**: Acting and music.
- **Reflex**: Swiftness and reaction time.

**Humanity**: Represents one's willpower and connection to their human nature.

- **Appearance**: Disguise and seduction.
- **Converse**: Persuasion and eloquence.
- **Insight**: Emotional intelligence and natural intuition.
- **Inspire**: Motivation and agitation.
- **Resist**: Determination and willpower.
- **Soothe**: De-escalation and pacification.

**Intellect**: Represents one's ability to take in information and solve complex problems.

- **Debug**: Exploitation and manipulation of software.
- **Decipher**: Decryption and deduction.
- **Interface**: Interact with complex systems and tools.
- **Know**: Recollection and connections.
- **Program**: Creating and modifying software.
- **Search**: Tracking and locating hidden things.

## STEP 1 :: BACKGROUNDS & OCCUPATIONS

The first step in creating a character is to choose a background and occupation from their respective tables. Each background and occupation comes with an amount of starting currency (Torrum) and a list of 5 skills. You may allocate 3 skill ranks each between the skills provided by your background and occupation.

You should also come up with one ally and one debt related to your background, and one enemy and one debt related to your occupation. Allies, enemies, and debts should be an individual or organization that can act as a plot hook for the DMM or as an asset you can call on for help. Debts may be monetary or more abstract, like a debt of gratitude, and the person or organization that holds the debt is more important than what is owed.

By the end of this step, your character should have 6 total skill ranks, some amount of Torrum, an ally, 2 debts, and an enemy.

## STEP 2 :: SKILL RANK ALLOCATION

In addition to the 6 skill ranks granted by your background and occupation, you may allocate 8 ranks freely between the skills on your character sheet. Once this step is done, your character should have 14 total skill ranks. Remember that no skill may exceed 3 ranks during the character creation process.

After allocating skill ranks, there are several stats derived from your skills. Each of your **trait scores**, Cool, Humanity, and Intellect, can be calculated by counting the total number of ranks in its related skills, dividing by 2 (rounded up), and adding 1. Your Trait points start out equal to your trait scores.

Your speed, stability points, and firewall are derived from your trait scores. Your Speed is equal to 5 + Cool. Your Stability Points are equal to 7 + Humanity. Your Firewall is equal to 10 + Intellect.

Finally, there are several stats that start off at a static value. Your Fatigue Limit is 3, you have 12 RAM, and you have 4 Hardware Slots.

## STEP 4 :: GEAR & ABILITIES

To finalize your character, you choose your character's starting gear and abilities. Cyberspace operators make use of a wide variety of Software to interact with and create effects in cyberspace.

Hyperstim weapons are a common software type used by corporate and pirate operators alike. They allow the user to create a weapon that significantly affects the stability of another entity in cyberspace. Other kinds of software are more tame, creating ongoing or instantaneous effects. You can start with up to 3 Software programs. It is recommended that at least one of them be a hyperstim weapon.

Hardware is another tool of the trade for Cyberspace Operators. These often illegal modifications to one's physical device can cause various static or triggered effects, generally




acting as a flat improvement to an Operator's natural abilities in Cyberspace. You have 4 hardware slots, but you can choose only one hardware upgrade as starting gear.

Operators in cyberspace gain access to unique abilities and powers related to their avata. These Avatar Abilities represent innate qualities of one's avatar, often related to an Operator's identity. These abilities allow Operators to do things that bend the rules of Cyberspace and differentiate them from the crowd. You may choose up to 2 starting abilities.

## TAKING ACTION

In The Torrent, players roll dice to determine the outcome of actions. The number of dice rolled can be affected by skills and other modifiers. There are two types of dice used in The Torrent: the Action Die and the Rank Dice.

The Action Die is a twelve-sided die (D12). You always roll exactly one when determining the result of using a Skill.

Rank Dice are six-sided dice (D6), which a player can roll up to 6 of when determining the result of using a Skill. The number of Rank Dice used depends on the Skill used.

## STANCE-BASED COMBAT

Stances represent an Operator's readiness to take certain types of actions. The stance you take during combat can affect your movement speed, grant rank die bonuses, and even determine your spot in the turn order. There are 4 stances: Forward, Neutral, Defensive, and Support.

Combat is resolved one Stance at a time. Each player in a Stance takes their Turn, followed by any NPCs in that Stance. If multiple players are in the same Stance, they must decide the order of their Turns amongst themselves

## MOMENTUM

Momentum represents a Crew's collective energy and collaborative flow. Momentum, individually known as Momentum Points, is a shared resource that can be generated or spent by any Crew member, stored in a Crew's Momentum Pool. The Crew can generate Momentum by rolling a 6 at any time on a Rank Die during a successful Skill Check. Each 6 rolled adds 1 Point to the Momentum Pool.

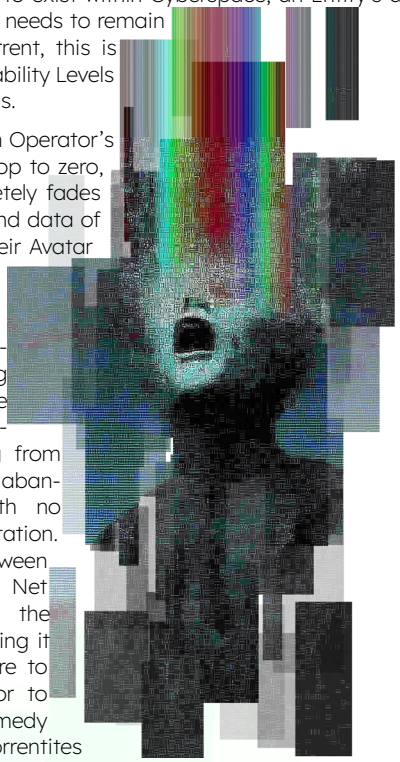
Spending Momentum allows players to add Rank Dice (D6) to their Skill Checks. Each Point spent adds one Rank Die. Momentum must be used as a lump sum, meaning that a player has to use all of it at once or none at all.

## STABILITY

When you jack into the Net, you are effectively transferring your consciousness out of your brain and onto the wider Net. Doing this makes your mind malleable and susceptible to damage from Cyberspace phenomena.

In order to exist within Cyberspace, an Entity's digital consciousness needs to remain stable. In The Torrent, this is represented by Stability Levels and Stability Points.

When an Operator's Stability Levels drop to zero, their mind completely fades into the background data of the Net, taking their Avatar with it.



## BROWSERS

Navigating the Navigating the Net can be dangerous, especially when going from place to place in abandoned areas with no formal transportation. The space between Domains on the Net is dangerous to the psyche, and entering it unprotected is sure to cause an operator to Destabilize. To remedy this problem, Torrentites created Browsers to explore the abandoned Net.

A Browser is a form of weaponized transportation designed to travel between Domains through Netspace. Operators piloting a browser enter a melded mental state with the other pilots, allowing them to combine their abilities and coordinate flawlessly as a single whole.

## RAM

RAM represents an Entity's capacity for running Software. Each Software requires a certain amount of RAM while it is running. RAM is not spent, it instead remains occupied for as long as the Software is running. This means that if you have 12 RAM, the combined RAM cost of concurrently running Software cannot exceed 12.

## SETTING

In the Year 2531, humanity spread far across the stars. The Board, the corporate rulers of known space, controls 13 star systems, 5 asteroid clusters, 11 planets, and 19 moons. Humanity, in its isolated settlements light-years apart from one another, is connected only by the Net, within which exists a world all of its own: Cyberspace.

What one sees when entering Cyberspace can vary. The landscape is created by the human mind's attempt to interpret digital architecture as physical space. The interpretive nature of Cyberspace means that although its functionality and shape are the same to most people, almost everyone experiences it slightly differently.

Much of Cyberspace exists solely as a digital workplace for corporations where they can monitor every facet of their employees' productivity. However, there are those who operate outside the rules of the corporations. These pirate operators have their own underground network within Cyberspace. The Torrent is the center of this network. A gleaming hidden city on the Net away from corporate scrutiny, it is both a hive of criminal scum and a heartland of art and expression. Each person who visits leaves their mark, making the city itself a collage of the raw, unfiltered human condition.

The Torrent rulebook is at DriveThruRPG, in both digital and print versions:

**https://legacy.drivethrurpg.com/product/565407/The-Torrent**

Or scan the QR code below!